SLEEP 09

Ipamorelin

Synthetic five-amino-acid growth hormone secretagogue, including amino acids not found in nature



CLASS Peptide (GH secretagogue)

STUDIED FOR Bowel recovery after surgery

HUMAN EVIDENCE Controlled human trials

US STATUS Not FDA approved · FDA Category 2 (503B)

STUDIED FOR

Bowel recovery
HUMAN + ANIMAL

Growth hormone
HUMAN + ANIMAL

No sleep study was found. In the bowel-surgery trial, time to the first tolerated meal did not differ significantly from placebo.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Ipamorelin → Ghrelin receptor → Pituitary → GH burst

- **Acts on the ghrelin receptor** in the pituitary to release GH
- **In pigs,** did not raise ACTH or cortisol, unlike GHRP-6 and GHRP-2
- **In healthy men,** one GH burst, peaking at about 40 minutes (by vein)
- **For sleep,** no effect or mechanism has been studied

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Phase II RCT, 117 adults: no significant benefit
- Second Phase II (320): no results posted
- No study of sleep

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Effect on sleep
- Long-term safety
- Safety of under-skin use
- Effects on fertility

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
About 2 hours (healthy men, by vein)

ROUTES STUDIED
Into a vein (trials)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Drug levels rose in proportion to the dose

SOLD AS
Not approved; FDA Category 2 for 503B compounding

MONITORED IN TRIALS
GH and drug levels; time to first meal, adverse events

SPORT (WADA)
Prohibited, class S2

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; Category 2 (503B) since Sep 2023
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide policy
TGA	Prescription-only (Schedule 4)
WADA	Prohibited (S2.2.4)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Category 2 bulk drug substances (significant safety risks), Apr 2026
2. Beck et al., Int J Colorectal Dis, ipamorelin after bowel surgery, Dec 2014
3. Gobburu et al., Pharm Res, ipamorelin in healthy men, Sep 1999

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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